SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

8 June 2022 · Shift 1

85 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 15 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 22 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The clock that we have in our town square is “a big” in the whole town

(A) the bigger
(B) the big
(C) the biggest
(D) a biggest

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Comic

(A) Native
(B) Costly
(C) Tragic
(D) Empty

Q.3

Complete the sentence with an appropriate ANTONYM of the word mentioned in the bracket. My fascination with Tyler's items _____(approached) into distant memories.

(A) receded
(B) escalated
(C) expanded
(D) intensified

Q.4

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. These carriers of bacteria and viruses cause many diseases like Yellow Fever, Malaria etc. so panchayats and municipalities are taking a lot of care to protect people from them. B. There are thousands of species of mosquitoes that are known to the people of the world. They mainly live in still water and other places where water is stored. C. Mosquitos are everywhere now. Villagers, as well as city dwellers are afraid of these small creatures. D. Usually, female and male mosquitoes take feed on plant’s or fruit honey, however female mosquitoes mostly suck the blood of humans.

(A) ADCB
(B) DABC
(C) CBAD
(D) ACBD

Q.5

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Easily provoked

(A) Invincible
(B) Irascible
(C) Iridescent
(D) Irrational

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Mr. Pramod couldn’t “wait to trying out” his new recipe.

(A) waited to try out
(B) wait for try out
(C) waited to try
(D) wait to try out

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Funny stories made me and my brother_____.

(A) conscious
(B) determined
(C) giggly
(D) gritty

Q.8

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. I know her.

(A) She is whom I know.
(B) She is known to me.
(C) She knows me.
(D) I am known by her.

Q.9

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Uniform

(A) Inflexible
(B) Variable
(C) Orderly
(D) Irrelevant

Q.10

The given sentence contains an error in tense form. Identify the error and choose the option that correctly rectifies the error. Bakshi will going to call you later in the evening.

(A) Bakshi was gone to call you later in the evening.
(B) Bakshi will go to call you later in the evening.
(C) Bakshi is going to call you later in the evening.
(D) Bakshi goes to call you later in the evening.

Q.11

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Upset the “apple-cart”

(A) Withdraw
(B) Spoil careful plans
(C) Consider unsatisfactory
(D) To be offended

Q.12

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. They attend / a meeting / in Chicago / this weekend.

(A) a meeting
(B) this weekend
(C) in Chicago
(D) They attend

Q.13

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word in the given sentence. His “perverse” thoughts were very disturbing so he decided to try seeing a therapist.

(A) Convergent
(B) Deviant
(C) Cynical
(D) Logical

Q.14

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Certificate
(B) Channel
(C) Champeon
(D) Challenge

Q.16

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. The rich man was known all throughout the country for his noble deeds, kindness and as “one who makes an active effort to promote human welfare.”

(A) Squanderer
(B) Spendthrift
(C) Pacifist
(D) Philanthropist

Q.17

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Pocket an insult

(A) Insult someone strongly
(B) Endure insult and protest
(C) Tolerate insult without protest
(D) Rebel against insult

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Settlers _____ a new colony in the early 18th century.

(A) fixed
(B) extended
(C) established
(D) entrenched

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There was once a young man who wished to (1)_____ his heart's desire. And while that is, as beginnings go, there was much about this young man and what happened to him that was unusual, (2)_____ even he never knew the whole of it. The tale started. The town of Wall stands today as it has (3)_____ for six hundred years, on a high (4)_____ of granite slab amidst small forest woodland. There is a road from Wall, a winding track rising sharply up from the forest, where it is (5)_____with rocks and small stones.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) appreciate
(B) achieve
(C) prevail
(D) value

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There was once a young man who wished to (1)_____ his heart's desire. And while that is, as beginnings go, there was much about this young man and what happened to him that was unusual, (2)_____ even he never knew the whole of it. The tale started. The town of Wall stands today as it has (3)_____ for six hundred years, on a high (4)_____ of granite slab amidst small forest woodland. There is a road from Wall, a winding track rising sharply up from the forest, where it is (5)_____with rocks and small stones.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) despite
(B) even though
(C) although
(D) in spite

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There was once a young man who wished to (1)_____ his heart's desire. And while that is, as beginnings go, there was much about this young man and what happened to him that was unusual, (2)_____ even he never knew the whole of it. The tale started. The town of Wall stands today as it has (3)_____ for six hundred years, on a high (4)_____ of granite slab amidst small forest woodland. There is a road from Wall, a winding track rising sharply up from the forest, where it is (5)_____with rocks and small stones.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) established
(B) stood
(C) erected
(D) edified

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There was once a young man who wished to (1)_____ his heart's desire. And while that is, as beginnings go, there was much about this young man and what happened to him that was unusual, (2)_____ even he never knew the whole of it. The tale started. The town of Wall stands today as it has (3)_____ for six hundred years, on a high (4)_____ of granite slab amidst small forest woodland. There is a road from Wall, a winding track rising sharply up from the forest, where it is (5)_____with rocks and small stones.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) furrow
(B) trench
(C) jut
(D) line

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. There was once a young man who wished to (1)_____ his heart's desire. And while that is, as beginnings go, there was much about this young man and what happened to him that was unusual, (2)_____ even he never knew the whole of it. The tale started. The town of Wall stands today as it has (3)_____ for six hundred years, on a high (4)_____ of granite slab amidst small forest woodland. There is a road from Wall, a winding track rising sharply up from the forest, where it is (5)_____with rocks and small stones.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) sequenced
(B) lined
(C) queued
(D) furnished

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. MASTER : AMHGRE :: LUXURY : ULCFYR :: FORMAL : ?

(A) OFMRAL
(B) OFAYLA
(C) OFYAAL
(D) OFINLA

Q.3

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 31*13*7*54*12*4*20

(A) =,÷,−,×,+,−
(B) +, ×,−,=, ×,+
(C) −,−,=,×,+,÷
(D) +,−,=,×,−,+

Q.4

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 96 * 3 * 5 * 56 * 16 * 120

(A) ÷, ×, −, +, =
(B) ×, ÷, +, −, =
(C) ÷, ×, +, −, =
(D) −, +, ÷, ×, =

Q.7

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 45*9*3*7*5*21

(A) ÷,+,×,−, =
(B) −,÷,+,×, =
(C) ×, +, ÷,−, =
(D) −,+, ×,÷, =

Q.8

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1. Elegant 2. Electrician 3. Elephant 4. Elated 5. Elongated

(A) 4, 5, 3, 1, 2
(B) 3, 5, 4, 1, 2
(C) 3, 4, 1, 2, 5
(D) 4, 2, 1, 3, 5

Q.9

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row: 124, 38, 100; Second row: 78, 25, 64; Third row: 94, 31, ? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the number into its constituent digits. For example, 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 84
(B) 80
(C) 74
(D) 78

Q.11

In a certain code language, “TAUGHT” is written as “VYWEJR”, and “SIMPLE” is written as “UGONNC”. How will “RETURN” be written in that language?

(A) TCWTTL
(B) TCVSTL
(C) TBVSTL
(D) TCWSTL

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'HONEST' is written as 'NTRHUU', and 'LABOUR' is written as 'RFFRWS'. How will 'ENOUGH' be written in that language?

(A) KSRYIJ
(B) KSSYJI
(C) KSSYII
(D) KSSXII

Q.14

Which letter cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? ETRE, HSPJ, KRNO, ?

(A) NPMT
(B) NQLT
(C) NPLT
(D) NQMT

Q.15

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 14, 26, 11, ?, 8, 32

(A) 29
(B) 22
(C) 25
(D) 18

Q.16

If ‘A’ denotes ‘+’, ‘B’ denotes ‘×’, ‘C’ denotes ‘–’ and ‘D’ denotes ‘÷’, then what will come in place of ‘?’ in the following equation? 18 A 23 C 6 B (96 D 16) A 3 B 12 = ?

(A) 44
(B) 41
(C) 20
(D) 31

Q.18

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 154, 165, 148, ?, 142, 177

(A) 174
(B) 162
(C) 171
(D) 168

Q.19

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (31, 26, 155); (18, 12, 108) (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed.)

(A) (16, 9, 114)
(B) (19, 15, 84)
(C) (17, 9, 136)
(D) (18, 10, 148)

Q.20

If 1 January 2020 was Wednesday, then what was the day of the week on 28 February 2021?

(A) Saturday
(B) Tuesday
(C) Monday
(D) Sunday

Q.21

Which of the following letter-clusters will replace the question mark (?) in the given series to make it logically complete? DWE, GTH, JQK, MNN, ?

(A) NOP
(B) PQK
(C) OPQ
(D) PKQ

Q.22

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 84 * 6 * 25 * 13 * 3

(A) ÷,+,=,×
(B) =,−,+,×
(C) +,÷,=,×
(D) −,−,=,+

Q.23

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 78, 97, 54, ?, 30, 145

(A) 113
(B) 121
(C) 115
(D) 107

Q.24

In a certain code language, ‘ACNE’ is written as ‘XZVM’ and ‘BODY’ is written as ‘LYBW’. How will ‘EVIL’ be written in that language?

(A) OVER
(B) VEOR
(C) EVOR
(D) ROEV

Quantitative Aptitude 20 questions

Q.2

If two supplementary angles differ by 74°, then one of the angles is:

(A) 65°
(B) 55°
(C) 43°
(D) 53°

Q.3

By selling an article for ₹255, there is a loss of 15%. When the article is sold for ₹357, the net result in the transaction is:

(A) 19% profit
(B) 17% loss
(C) 19% loss
(D) 17% profit

Q.4

The difference between a single discount of 20% and two successive discounts of 16% and 4% on a bill of ₹50,000 is:

(A) ₹450
(B) ₹240
(C) ₹320
(D) nil

Q.5

Kuldeep offers his customers a discount of 10% on the marked price of a suitcase and he still makes a profit of 20%. What is the actual cost of the suitcase marked for ₹2,500?

(A) ₹1,860
(B) ₹1,875
(C) ₹1,865
(D) ₹1,870

Q.7

X does a work in 6 days, while Y does it in 12 days. If they work alternatively and X begins, in how many days will the work be finished?

(A) 7
(B) 5
(C) 8
(D) 6

Q.8

What should be subtracted from 246837 to make it divisible by 13 ?

(A) 5
(B) 6
(C) 3
(D) 4

Q.9

The fourth proportional to 14,21,28 is:

(A) 46
(B) 40
(C) 42
(D) 44

Q.10

After spending 20% of his salary on grocery and 30% of the remainder on monthly house rent, a man is left with ₹8,400. What is his monthly salary?

(A) ₹42,000
(B) ₹28,000
(C) ₹16,800
(D) ₹15,000

Q.11

A car travelled distances of 10 km, 20 km and 30 km at speeds of 30 km/h, 40 km/h and 60 km/h, respectively. The average speed of the car is:

(A) 45 km/h
(B) 20 km/h
(C) 30 km/h
(D) 40 km/h

Q.13

The distance between stations A and B is 778 kilometres. A train travels from station A to station B at a uniform speed of 84 km/h and then returns to station A at a uniform speed of 56 km/h. What is the train's average speed (in km/h) throughout the journey?

(A) 63.4
(B) 66
(C) 67.2
(D) 65

Q.14

Two numbers are less than a third number by 30% and 37% respectively. By how much is the second number lesser than the first?

(A) 3%
(B) 7%
(C) 4%
(D) 10%

Q.15

Ramesh bought a house for ₹2,00,000. At the end of the first year, he sold it at a loss of 10% on his investment. He invested the money thus obtained at a rate of 20% p.a. interest compounded aunually for 2 years. The value of this investment would amount to _____.

(A) ₹2,59,200
(B) ₹2,52,300
(C) ₹2,56,900
(D) ₹2,54,600

Q.16

tan (π + θ) = ?

(A) secθ
(B) cosecθ
(C) cotθ
(D) tanθ

Q.17

Number B is 17.5% less than number A, while number C is 22.5% more than number B. If the value of C is given as 8085, what is the value of A?

(A) 7800
(B) 7750
(C) 8000
(D) 8100

Q.19

If 9 × 4 of 3 ÷ 2 - 5 × Q + 2 × 3 = 10, then find the value of Q.

(A) 10
(B) 0.2
(C) 0.1
(D) 5

Q.20

The average of the four numbers, given in a particular order, is 48. The average of the first three numbers is 42, while the average of the last three numbers is 50. What is the average of the first and last numbers?

(A) 54
(B) 55
(C) 56
(D) 53

Q.21

In a school, the final grades of a subject for an academic year are calculated, based on the grades that a student gets in his assignments, tests and a final exam. Assignments have the weightage of 28%, tests of 22%, and the final exam of 50%. If a student has an assignment grade of 80, a test grade of 75, an exam grade of 86, then his overall grade for the year is _____.

(A) 81.9
(B) 80.5
(C) 84.6
(D) 90.2

Q.22

The total surface area of a hemisphere is 64.57 cm^2. Find its curved surface area.

(A) 64.57 cm^2
(B) 53.44 cm^2
(C) 43.04 cm^2
(D) 33.04 cm^2

Q.23

The expression $x^4 – 8x^2 + m$ will be a perfect square when the value of m is:

(A) 2
(B) 16
(C) 8
(D) 4

Q.24

A wall 10 m long, 5 m high and 20 cm thick is to be constructed using bricks of dimensions 25 cm × 20 cm × 10 cm. How many bricks are required?

(A) 2450
(B) 2000
(C) 2500
(D) 2050

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

In which year will India host the 15th Men's Hockey World Cup?

(A) 2025
(B) 2023
(C) 2022
(D) 2024

Q.2

Income of the state which arises out of the property left by the people without a legal heir is called _____.

(A) escheat
(B) writ
(C) de novo
(D) felony

Q.3

In the case of Aparna Bhat vs State of Madhya Pradesh in 2021, the Supreme Court set aside the judgment of Madhya Pradesh High Court which prescribed _____ as condition for bail.

(A) giving money
(B) getting married
(C) tying rakhi
(D) giving job

Q.4

Who among the following is a 19th century exponent of the Kathak dance?

(A) Jatin Goswami
(B) Kalka Prasad
(C) Bhabhananda Barbayan
(D) Krishna Panicker

Q.5

Who among the following was one of the founders of Kerala Kalalayam in 1952?

(A) Pallavi Krishnan
(B) Rema Shrikant
(C) Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma
(D) Sunanda Nair

Q.6

Who proposed the 'plum pudding' theory of the divisible atom in which negatively charged electrons were scattered in a lump of positive charge like a raisin in plum pudding?

(A) Robert Andrews Millikan
(B) Ernest Rutherford
(C) Sir JJ Thomson
(D) Henri Becquerel

Q.7

In India, from where do the tropical cyclones, which enter the Indian subcontinent from the west and the northwest during the winter months, originate?

(A) Over the Gulf of Khambhat
(B) Over the Arabian Sea
(C) Over the Gulf of Mannar
(D) Over the Mediterranean Sea

Q.8

In April 2021, which Indian cricketer was named as 'Wisden Almanack's ODI Cricketer of 2010s in the 2021 edition of the Wisden Cricketers' Almanack?

(A) Hardik Pandya
(B) K L Rahul
(C) Mahendra Singh Dhoni
(D) Virat Kohli

Q.9

Who was the winner of the 7th ICC T20 World Cup cricket?

(A) Australia
(B) Sri Lanka
(C) New Zealand
(D) England

Q.10

Who published the book 'Method de nomenclature (System of Chemical Nomenclature)' along with Claude Berthollet and others that determined the modern method of naming substances?

(A) Jacob Berzelius
(B) Georg Brandt
(C) Antoine Lavoisier
(D) Wilhelm Ostwald

Q.11

Which of the following State Governments started the Lata Mangeshkar Award in 1984?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Gujarat

Q.12

R Muthukannammal is a _____ dancer who got the Padma Shri in 2022.

(A) Jhora
(B) Khor
(C) Daph
(D) Sadhir

Q.13

A pyramid of biomass is a diagram that shows the population at each level of the food chain. Accordingly, _____ occupy the base with the highest biomass.

(A) secondary consumers
(B) Decomposers
(C) primary consumers
(D) producers

Q.14

Which of the following names belong to Bharatanatyam ?

(A) Pandit Birju Maharaj
(B) Dr. Narthaki Natraj
(C) Kelucharan Mohapatra
(D) Guru Bipin Singh

Q.15

Which chemical compound, with the chemical formula CH_3CH_2Cl, is used as a blowing agent in foamed plastics?

(A) 3-Chlorohexane
(B) 1-chloropropane
(C) Chloromethane
(D) Chloroethane

Q.16

Who among the following Indian music directors introduced Western tunes in the Hindi film industry, who was popularly known as ‘Pancham Da’?

(A) Salil Chowdhury
(B) Vijaya Bhaskar
(C) Omkar Prasad Nayyar
(D) Rahul Dev Burman

Q.17

Who was famous for the invention of the vacuum pump in the 17th century and also pioneered the concept of the absolute vacuum of space, measured the weight of air and used air pressure to predict the weather?

(A) John Cockcroft
(B) Otto von Guericke
(C) Enrico Fermi
(D) Valerianus Magnus

Q.18

What is the common name of the members of family Phaeophyceae?

(A) Green algae
(B) Red algae
(C) Brown algae
(D) Blue green algae

Q.19
'Jakhan Choto Chilam' is an autobiography written in the Bengali language by which of the following Indian Bangla film directors?

(A) Rituparno Ghosh
(B) Mrinal Sen
(C) Satyajit Ray
(D) Tapan Sinha

Q.20
Who among the following personalities was awarded the Padma Shri for his contribution to Bundeli Folk Dance in 2022?

(A) Ravi Shankar Sharma
(B) Dinesh Kumar Barkesia
(C) Anil Kumar Raghupati
(D) Ram Sahay Pandey

Q.21
Pandit Ravi Shankar was one of the best known players of the _____.

(A) Sitar
(B) Sarangi
(C) Sarod
(D) Tabala

Q.22
The Fifteenth Finance Commission was constituted in:

(A) 2016
(B) 2017
(C) 2018
(D) 2019

Q.23
In which of the following categories did the weightlifter Mirabai Chanu bag a silver medal at the Tokyo Olympics 2020?

(A) 55 kg
(B) 49 kg
(C) 64 kg
(D) 59 kg

Q.24
Which of the following novels by Krishna Sobti was originally published as 'Dilo-Danish'?

(A) Memory's Daughter
(B) The Music of Solitude
(C) A Gujarat Here, A Gujarat There
(D) The Heart Has its Reasons

Q.25
Which of the following awards was conferred on Krishna Sobti in the year 1980 for her Hindi novel 'Zindaginama'?

(A) Sahitya Akademi Award
(B) Saraswati Samman
(C) Jnanpith Award
(D) Vyas Samman

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**
Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(B)**		

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**
Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (C) the biggest

'In the whole town' calls for the superlative with 'the': 'is the biggest in the whole town'.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Tragic

'Comic' means funny; its opposite is 'tragic'.

Q.3 · Answer (A) receded

To 'approach' is to come nearer; its opposite, to 'recede', is to move back or grow fainter: the fascination 'receded into distant memories'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) CBAD

C introduces mosquitoes, B says how many species there are and where they live, A names the diseases these carriers spread, and D ends with what they feed on: CBAD.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Irascible

An 'irascible' person is easily angered. 'Invincible' means unbeatable and 'iridescent' showing shifting rainbow colours.

Q.6 · Answer (D) wait to try out

'Couldn't' takes the base form 'wait', and 'wait' takes the to-infinitive 'to try', not 'to trying': 'couldn't wait to try out his new recipe'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) giggly

Funny stories set them giggling: they made them 'giggly'.

Q.8 · Answer (B) She is known to me.

In the passive 'know' takes 'to', not 'by': 'She is known to me.'

Q.9 · Answer (B) Variable

'Uniform' means the same throughout; its opposite is 'variable'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Bakshi is going to call you later in the evening.

'Will' cannot be followed by 'going'; a planned future action takes 'is going to': 'Bakshi is going to call you later in the evening.'

Q.11 · Answer (B) Spoil careful plans

To 'upset the apple-cart' is to spoil someone's careful plans.

Q.12 · Answer (D) They attend

A personal arrangement for 'this weekend' takes the present continuous (or 'will'), not the simple present 'They attend': 'They are attending (or will attend) a meeting in Chicago this weekend.'

Q.13 · Answer (B) Deviant

'Perverse' here means abnormal and unacceptable: 'deviant'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Champeon

The correct spelling is 'champion'.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Philanthropist

A philanthropist works to promote the welfare of others, especially by giving money. A spendthrift or squanderer wastes money, and a pacifist opposes war.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Tolerate insult without protest

To 'pocket an insult' is to put up with it without protest.

Q.18 · Answer (C) established
Settlers found, or 'established', a colony; 'entrenched' means firmly fixed, and 'fixed' and 'extended' do not fit a new colony.

Q.21 · Answer (B) achieve
To 'achieve' one's heart's desire is to attain it.

Q.22 · Answer (C) although
'Although' joins two contrasting clauses: 'unusual, although even he never knew the whole of it'. 'Despite' and 'in spite' need a noun, and 'even though even' repeats 'even'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) stood
The town 'stands today as it has stood for six hundred years': the present perfect of 'stand'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) jut
A 'jut' is a part that sticks out: the town is on a high jut of granite.

Q.25 · Answer (B) lined
A track 'lined with rocks' has them along its sides.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (D) OFINLA
Take the letters in pairs: the first and last pairs swap (MA → AM, ER → RE) and each letter of the middle pair becomes its opposite in the alphabet (S → H, T → G). So FO → OF, RM → IN and AL → LA: OFINLA.

Q.3 · Answer (B) +, ×,−,=, ×,+
31 + 13 × 7 − 54 = 12 × 4 + 20: 31 + 91 − 54 = 68 and 48 + 20 = 68.

Q.4 · Answer (A) ÷, ×, −, +, =
96 ÷ 3 × 5 − 56 + 16 = 120: 32 × 5 = 160 and 160 − 56 + 16 = 120.

Q.7 · Answer (A) ÷,+,×,−, =
45 ÷ 9 + 3 × 7 − 5 = 21: 5 + 21 − 5 = 21.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 4, 2, 1, 3, 5
Elated (4), Electrician (2), Elegant (1), Elephant (3), Elongated (5): 'Ela' comes before 'Ele', the 'Ele' words follow their fourth letters c, g, p, and 'Elo' comes last.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 78
In each row the third number is half the first plus the second: 124 ÷ 2 + 38 = 100 and 78 ÷ 2 + 25 = 64. So 94 ÷ 2 + 31 = 78.

Q.11 · Answer (B) TCVSTL
The letters move 2 forward and 2 back in turn: TAUGHT → VYWEJR and SIMPLE → UGONNC. So RETURN → TCVSTL.

Q.13 · Answer (D) KSSXII
The letters move forward 6, 5, 4, 3, 2 and 1 places: HONEST → NTRHUU and LABOUR → RFFRWS. So ENOUGH → KSSXII.

Q.14 · Answer (B) NQLT
First letters move +3 (E, H, K, N), second letters −1 (T, S, R, Q), third letters −2 (R, P, N, L) and fourth letters +5 (E, J, O, T): NQLT.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 29
Two series alternate: 14, 11, 8 falls by 3 and 26, 29, 32 rises by 3.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 41
After substituting the signs: 18 + 23 − 6 × (96 ÷ 16) + 3 × 12 = 18 + 23 − 36 + 36 = 41.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 171
Two series alternate: 154, 148, 142 falls by 6 and 165, 171, 177 rises by 6.

Q.19 · Answer (C) (17, 9, 136)
The third number is the first times the difference of the first two: (31 – 26) × 31 = 155 and (18 – 12) × 18 = 108. Likewise (17 – 9) × 17 = 136; the other sets would need 112, 76 and 144.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Sunday
2020 was a leap year, so 1 January 2021 came 366 days later, two weekdays on: Friday. 28 February 2021 is 58 days after that, 8 weeks and 2 days: Sunday.

Q.21 · Answer (D) PKQ
First letters move +3 (D, G, J, M, P), second letters –3 (W, T, Q, N, K) and third letters +3 (E, H, K, N, Q): PKQ.

Q.22 · Answer (A) ÷,+,=,×
84 ÷ 6 + 25 = 13 × 3: 14 + 25 = 39 and 13 × 3 = 39.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 121
Two series alternate: 78, 54, 30 falls by 24 and 97, 121, 145 rises by 24.

Q.24 · Answer (C) EVOR
Each letter becomes its opposite in the alphabet and the letters of each pair then swap: ACNE → ZXMV → XZVM and BODY → YLWB → LYBW. So EVIL → VERO → EVOR.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 · Answer (D) 53°
x + y = 180° and x – y = 74°, so the angles are 127° and 53°.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 19% profit
Cost price = 255 ÷ 0.85 = ₹300. At ₹357 the profit is ₹57, and 57/300 = 19%.

Q.4 · Answer (C) ₹320
The two discounts leave 0.84 × 0.96 = 0.8064 of the bill, a total discount of 19.36%. The difference, 0.64% of ₹50,000, is ₹320.

Q.5 · Answer (B) ₹1,875
Selling price = 0.9 × 2,500 = ₹2,250, which is 120% of the cost: 2,250 ÷ 1.2 = ₹1,875.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 8
In each two-day pair X and Y do 1/6 + 1/12 = 1/4 of the work, so four pairs, 8 days, finish it.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 6
13 × 18987 = 246831, so 246837 leaves remainder 6 on division by 13; subtracting 6 makes it divisible.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 42
14 : 21 = 28 : x, so x = 21 × 28 ÷ 14 = 42.

Q.10 · Answer (D) ₹15,000
After 20% on grocery and 30% of the rest on rent, 0.8 × 0.7 = 0.56 of the salary is left: 8,400 ÷ 0.56 = ₹15,000.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 45 km/h
Time = 10/30 + 20/40 + 30/60 = 1/3 + 1/2 + 1/2 = 4/3 hours for 60 km: 60 ÷ 4/3 = 45 km/h.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 67.2
Over equal distances the average speed is 2 × 84 × 56/(84 + 56) = 9,408/140 = 67.2 km/h; the distance itself does not matter.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 10%
If the third number is 100, the other two are 70 and 63. The second is 7 less than the first: 7/70 = 10%.

Q.15 · Answer (A) ₹2,59,200
He sold at 90% of ₹2,00,000 = ₹1,80,000. At 20% compounded for 2 years: 1,80,000 × 1.2 × 1.2 = ₹2,59,200.

Q.16 · Answer (D) tanθ
π + θ lies in the third quadrant, where the tangent is positive, and tan has period π: tan (π + θ) = tanθ.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 8000
B = 0.825A and C = 1.225B = 1.010625A, so A = 8085 ÷ 1.010625 = 8000.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 10
'Of' comes first: 4 of 3 = 12. Then 9 × 12 ÷ 2 − 5Q + 6 = 10, so 54 + 6 − 5Q = 10, 5Q = 50 and Q = 10.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 54
The four numbers add to 192. The first three add to 126, so the fourth is 66; the last three add to 150, so the first is 42. (42 + 66)/2 = 54.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 81.9
Weighted average: 0.28 × 80 + 0.22 × 75 + 0.50 × 86 = 22.4 + 16.5 + 43 = 81.9.

Q.22 · Answer (C) 43.04 cm²
The total surface area is $3\pi r^2$ and the curved surface $2\pi r^2$, two-thirds of it: 2/3 × 64.57 = 43.046… cm², the 43.04 cm² of the options.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 16
$x^4 - 8x^2 + 16 = (x^2 - 4)^2$, so m = 16.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 2000
The wall is 1,000 cm × 500 cm × 20 cm and a brick 25 cm × 20 cm × 10 cm = 5,000 cm³: (1,000 × 500 × 20) ÷ 5,000 = 2,000 bricks.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) 2023
India hosted the 15th Men's Hockey World Cup in January 2023, at Bhubaneswar and Rourkela in Odisha.

Q.2 · Answer (A) escheat
Escheat is property that passes to the State when its owner dies without a legal heir; Article 296 of the Constitution vests such property in the State or the Union.

Q.3 · Answer (C) tying rakhi
In March 2021 the Supreme Court set aside the Madhya Pradesh High Court's bail condition that a man accused of sexual assault visit the complainant with a rakhi and ask her to tie it on him.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Kalka Prasad
Kalka Prasad and his brother Bindadin Maharaj were the great 19th-century masters of the Lucknow gharana of Kathak; Birju Maharaj was Kalka Prasad's grandson.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma
Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma, the Mohiniyattam dancer, set up Kerala Kalalayam at Tripunithura in 1952 with her husband, the Kathakali artist Kalamandalam Krishnan Nair.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Sir JJ Thomson
J. J. Thomson, who discovered the electron, proposed the plum pudding model of the atom in 1904.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Over the Mediterranean Sea
The western disturbances, the cyclonic depressions that enter north-west India in winter, originate over the Mediterranean Sea and are brought into India by the westerly jet stream.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Virat Kohli
In its 2021 edition Wisden named Virat Kohli its ODI Cricketer of the Decade for the 2010s.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Australia
The seventh T20 World Cup, held in the UAE and Oman in 2021, was won by Australia, who beat New Zealand in the final.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Antoine Lavoisier
Lavoisier wrote 'Méthode de nomenclature chimique' (1787) with Guyton de Morveau, Berthollet and Fourcroy; it laid the basis of modern chemical names.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Madhya Pradesh
Madhya Pradesh instituted the National Lata Mangeshkar Award for light music in 1984.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Sadhir
R. Muthukannammal of Viralimalai, Tamil Nadu, one of the last exponents of Sadhir, the temple dance from which Bharatanatyam developed, received the Padma Shri in 2022.

Q.13 · Answer (D) producers
In an upright pyramid of biomass the producers, the green plants, form the base, with the greatest biomass of any level.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Dr. Narthaki Natraj
Narthaki Nataraj, a Bharatanatyam dancer, was the first transgender person to receive the Padma Shri, in 2019. Birju Maharaj danced Kathak, Kelucharan Mohapatra Odissi and Guru Bipin Singh Manipuri.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Chloroethane
CH_3CH_2Cl, an ethane with one hydrogen replaced by chlorine, is chloroethane (ethyl chloride). Chloromethane is CH_3Cl and 1-chloropropane $CH_3CH_2CH_2Cl$.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Rahul Dev Burman
Rahul Dev Burman, son of S. D. Burman, was known as 'Pancham Da'; he brought Western tunes and rhythms into Hindi film music.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Otto von Guericke
Otto von Guericke built the first air pump around 1650, showed the force of air pressure with the Magdeburg hemispheres and used a barometer to forecast the weather.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Brown algae
Phaeophyceae are the brown algae, such as kelps, coloured by the pigment fucoxanthin.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Satyajit Ray
'Jakhan Choto Chilam' is Satyajit Ray's memoir of his childhood, published in English as 'Childhood Days'.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Ram Sahay Pandey
Ram Sahay Pandey of Sagar, Madhya Pradesh, received the Padma Shri in 2022 for his life's work on Rai, the folk dance of Bundelkhand.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Sitar
Pandit Ravi Shankar was the best-known sitar player of the twentieth century.

Q.22 · Answer (B) 2017
The Fifteenth Finance Commission, chaired by N. K. Singh, was constituted under Article 280 in November 2017.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 49 kg
Mirabai Chanu won silver in the women's 49 kg weightlifting at Tokyo 2020, India's first medal of those Games.

Q.24 · Answer (D) The Heart Has its Reasons
Krishna Sobti's 'Dil-o-Danish' appeared in English in 2005 as 'The Heart Has Its Reasons', translated by Reema Anand and Meenakshi Swami.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Sahitya Akademi Award

Krishna Sobti won the Sahitya Akademi Award in 1980 for 'Zindaginama'; she later received the Jnanpith Award (2017).

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